

r/EventPlanners · 6mo ago

No_Leader_3640

What portals do you use?

Hi everyone! New-er wedding planner here, looking for some input from other event / wedding planners.

I've been in the business a few years now, and am looking to upgrade my client experience, but get lost on where to start. I see other planners out there advertise "custom client portals" to their customers, but am confused on what that means - are y'all really hosting portals somewhere, and if so, where are we going?! Do you use something like Notion, or more specific platforms like PlanningPod, Aisle Planner That'sTheOne, etc? And do these portals host your RSVPs as well, or do you outsource for that one?

Personally I've been using a shared Google Drive with all my couples, and have created an extensive Google Sheets to follow everything along. I figured it was something most people already have access to and experience with, so the learning curve is short/ nonexistent. I want to look more professional than just using Google Sheets, and attract higher clientele, but I feel like if I signed on with an event planner and got forced to use something new, I'd be pretty stressed. I also don't want to drop money on something my clients would hate.

Tldr; What do you use for client portals to plan events, and do you hear any feedback on new-platform frustrations?

10

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LeighBee212 · 6mo ago

I also just use google sheets, because I find it's the best way to loop in the wedding party and other vendors. I like that it updates in real time so if I have to edit the timeline day of, it auto updates for all of the vendors too.

5

No_Leader_3640 OP · 6mo ago

Glad I'm on the right track, at least! I just worry it doesn't come off "professional" enough, even though I know what I'm doing, you know?

2

LeighBee212 · 6mo ago

Do you have a business Gmail account? I feel like name@businessname always comes across more professional than name@gmail

3

3 more replies

singlemomtothree · 6mo ago

The planners I know create a shared Google Drive for their clients. It's all customized and looks super professional. The clients love it because it's easy and familiar for them and the planners love it because everything is in one spot for everyone who needs to reference it.

3

No_Leader_3640 OP · 6mo ago

Ok, that's reassuring to hear. I was / am worried when I read other planners offering a "custom client portal" that I was missing something.

I use Google Drive for the same pros - familiar, easy to customize

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https://www.reddit.com/r/EventPlanners/comments/1q4rux5/what_portals_do_you_use/

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motioncru · 6mo ago

A lot of "custom portals" are really just branded wrappers around tools clients already know. What seems to matter more than the platform is how much friction it removes.

We've found that keeping the core workflow on familiar tools (Drive/Docs/Sheets) and layering structure on top works better than forcing clients into something new. If you do introduce a platform, it helps when it's optional or phased in — clients usually engage more when they don't feel trapped.

The most consistent feedback we hear is that clients care about clarity and visibility, not features. A simple system that's clearly organized often feels more "premium" than a complex portal they don't fully use.



No_Leader_3640 OP · 6mo ago

This is the exact advice I was looking for, thank you!



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440Elm_Vijay · 6mo ago

I'm a bit lost on the purpose. You generally don't want software for softwares sake. Do you have something you're trying to do that you're not finding or are you trying to get a sense of what other people use this category to do and why?



No_Leader_3640 OP · 6mo ago

More of the latter. I find higher-end planners offer "custom client portals" and am unclear what that entails, or if it's something clients even care about.



oso_events · 6mo ago

We use Aisle Planner. I prefer to have all of our branding to be as cohesive as possible. I am very adept at building Google sheets, can automate everything/write my own code to have it automated, but choose not to because I do not want to maintain my own software ecosystem. Also, to track everything across all of our clients manually, was really, really frustrating.

I prefer to have everything for our clients and team in one place because it's more intuitive than email + texting + drive + a floor plan software. It works really well for us and we go through a mini tutorial on our kick-off calls. All of our clients prefer it to a spreadsheet.



No_Leader_3640 OP · 6mo ago

This is a great review of it, thank you! I've been eyeing Aisle Planner, but am always shocked by the pricing structure



oso_events · 6mo ago

It's definitely so expensive for what it is. I've been reviewing other software, would strongly suggest looking into PlanPage. We can't make the jump as easily because we already have software but it's definitely worth looking into!



Find anything

Ask



Legamspector4127 · 6mo ago

This is exactly the gap a lot of planners are feeling right now. Most of us already use solid tools like Duhsado Google Drive Sheets etc. The issue is not that those tools are bad it is that clients experience

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Dubsado, Google Drive, Sheets, etc. The issue is not that these tools are bad, it is that clients experience them as fragmented.

I am building something called **VowSpace** specifically for this use case. It is not meant to replace Dubsado or force couples into learning a dozen new systems. It gives planners a clean, branded client-facing hub where everything lives in one place from the client's point of view.

Contracts, invoices, timelines, docs, galleries, RSVP links, whatever you already use, all stay where they are. VowSpace just becomes the single "front door" so clients are not confused about where to go or what happens next.

From the planners testing it so far, the biggest feedback is that it *feels* more professional to clients without adding friction or stress.

If anyone is curious, I am opening a small number of early access spots right now and would love feedback from real planners as this is being built.

1 upvote

No_Leader_3640 OP · 6mo ago

This is a really interesting site! I'd be intersedt to see what the planner's side of things are, since it doesn't look like there's a place to sign up. Right now it looks more garnered towards couples, not professionals, am I right?

1 upvote

LegalInspector4127 · 6mo ago

That's a fair question, and you're not wrong in how it comes across right now.

There is a public sign-up flow for planners today, but it's intentionally not pushed front and center yet. The couple experience was surfaced first because that's where confusion usually shows up fastest, but VowSpace is very much built as a **planner-first CRM and planning system**, not an add-on or overlay.

From the planner side, VowSpace handles client management, weddings, timelines, tasks, vendors, documents, communication, RSVPs, and the client-facing website all in one place. The difference compared to a lot of legacy tools is that the system is designed around *how couples experience planning*, not just internal workflow density. Clients don't feel like they're being dropped into a complicated piece of software, even though there's a full CRM running behind the scenes.

Planners can absolutely run their process fully inside VowSpace. Some planners still keep external tools during transitions, but the platform itself is intended to be complete, not a wrapper.

At this stage, I'm actively looking for planners who are thoughtful about client experience and willing to share honest feedback as the planner side continues to mature. That feedback directly influences how workflows, defaults, and planner-facing features are shaped.

If you're interested, I'm happy to walk through the planner dashboard and hear your thoughts. I've been offering extended complimentary access to a small group of planners specifically for feedback during this phase.

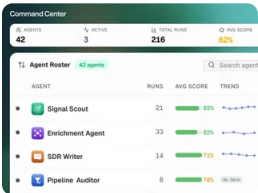
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TourmalineTaurus · 5mo ago

So happy to hear so many people using google drive! I've spend the past few weeks on calls and doing demos for platforms and nothing has made me want to move to them from (free!) google drive

1 upvote

No_Leader_3640 OP · 5mo ago

Same here! Out of curiosity, how do you handle RSVP tracking?

1 upvote

TourmalineTaurus · 5mo ago

Just switched to eventeny. Haven't gone live yet but it is looking good so far

1 upvote



TicketsCandy · 6mo ago

This just means one clean place for info. PlanningPod/Aisle Planner help if you want contracts, timelines, and RSVPs in one spot, but they add a little bit of learning curve.

2 up 2 down



SorryTangerine7096 · 6mo ago

Hey What are you looking for in your portal? Like what kinds of things do you want to display and what do you want your client to be able to do? I may have some solutions for you but wanna make sure I'm giving you the proper advice.

1 up 1 down



krakoan · 6mo ago

If anyone is still interested in solving all your event planner issues, I am building a platform to help you plan better, use AI, elevate your presence with customers, connect with vendors, and much more. All in all, it's something to help you run your business, plan your work, and communicate with clients and vendors all in one place.

I have got most of it down, but if you would like, just reply here with your top 3 problems. Keep in touch, and I will send out an invite link too if we have solved your problems already.

Cheers!

1 up 1 down



harpsenevents · 6mo ago

Give Harpsen a try - we designed it exactly for this and we keep the price small business affordable!

DM me if you any specific questions:)

1 up 1 down



Designer_Heron2900 · 3mo ago

I've been using Coordon recently, and it's been pretty good so far.

1 up 1 down

1 more reply



[deleted] · 6mo ago

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